

Lionel a Marca's favourite timepiece, the Breguet Tradition Ref. 7057

WATCH
TREND

Rolex is far from alone it its desire to take control of the secondary market. Vacheron Constantin launched its own CPO programme in November 2024, joining the likes of Audemars Piguet, Cartier, F. P. Journe, MB&F, Richard Mille, Urwerk, and Zenith to name a few.

Consumer benefits

There are many benefits for the consumer when it comes to brand CPO, starting with the fact that the watch brands and their experts carefully curate the timepieces on offer. For watch lovers who aren't necessarily experts in the field of vintage watchmaking, this can reassure them that the timepiece is historically and technically interesting and far more likely to retain its value, although of course, there are no guarantees.



CPO watches and their movements are also refurbished so that they are in perfect working order, bringing an extra level of trust into the equation. In the case of Vacheron Constantin, the brand has a library of spare parts, dating back over its 268-year history, so it can often replace used components with the exact same ones from the era the watch was made. All of the above comes with an additional guarantee in case anything goes wrong, taking the risk and worry out of purchasing a vintage timepiece.

There is an additional cost to such a service with a CPO premium; this is the increase in the cost of a certified watch compared to a non-certified timepiece. In the case of Rolex, the CPO premium typically falls between 15 per cent and 30 per cent, depending on the reference and the market.

At the end of the day, it is up to the consumer whether they prefer to pay the extra for guarantees and peace of mind, or to continue to search for the best deals with non-authorised dealers. Of course, at the high-end, seasoned watch enthusiasts will continue to trust in auction houses and independent vintage specialists, where the provenance and condition of a watch will always matter more than a brand CPO stamp.

Overall, brand CPO timepieces should help the pre-owned watch segment to become more regulated and curb speculation and soaring prices, not to mention bring extra security and reassurance to consumers. But as always, only time will tell.